Skip to main content UXDesign × Search in r/UXDesign Create 2

r/UXDesign • 1y ago
SnowflakeSlayer420

Examples of Genius UX Design

Articles, videos & educational resources

What are some examples of UX that are considered extremely high level. I'm really eager to learn and improve but think that currently I'm quite average at this, would like to understand what is considered "genius" level UX

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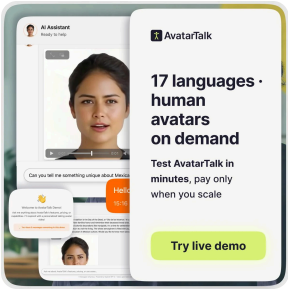

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Secret-Training-1984 • 1y ago
Experienced

Netflix's "Skip Intro" button is a great example of smart UX design imo. It solves a real problem that many of us have faced - the annoyance of sitting through the same TV intro over and over during a binge-watching session.

What makes it clever is its simplicity. It's just a button that appears when the intro starts, letting you jump right into the episode. But that small change makes a big difference in how we watch TV shows.

The button respects viewer choice. Want to watch the intro? Go ahead. Tired of it? Skip it. This kind of user control is key to good UX.

From Netflix's perspective, it's a win-win. Viewers get a better experience and Netflix likely sees increased watch time. Plus they gain insights into viewing habits.

The success of this feature is clear - it's now standard across streaming platforms. It shows how solving even small user frustrations can significantly impact overall satisfaction.

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340

harivel • 1y ago

Hacker News
new | past | comments | ask | show | jobs | submit
login

rsweeney21 on July 30, 2019 | parent | context | favorite | on: New bill would ban autoplay videos and endless scr...

I'm the dev that built Netflix's autoplay of the next episode. We built it first on the web player because it is easy to A/B test new features there. We called it "post-play" at the time.

When I worked there the product team at Netflix had two KPIs all new features were tested against: hours watched and retention. We would come up with all sorts of ideas to try out, and release them to small user populations of about 100,000 or so. It was great because you didn't have to debate much about whether a new feature was a good idea or not, you just built it and tested it. If the feature didn't increase hours watched or retention in a statistically significant way, the feature was removed.

Autoplay massively increased hours watched. I can't remember the exact numbers, but it was by far the biggest increase in the hours watched KPI of any feature we ever tested. There was some skepticism about whether the number was inflated by Netflix continuing to play when the user left the room.

As part of the autoplay test, we tested how long the countdown should be between episodes. 5 seconds, 10 seconds or 15 seconds. 10 seconds caused the biggest increase in hours watched. We thought that it gave people time to digest what they had just watched, but wasn't too fast (5 seconds) where it became jarring. Interestingly, Netflix recently changed the countdown between episodes to 5 seconds. That means they tested it out and found that people watch more if with a shorter countdown. This didn't use to be the case. Netflix user have become conditioned to expect autoplay.

So yes, Netflix wants you to spend more hours watching Netflix and the product team is scientifically engineering the product to make it more addictive.

But...the product team at Doritos does the same thing.

Most interesting a/b testing

75

itsshadyhere • 1y ago
Midweight

It's funny how this dev speaks like testing a concept to see if it holds against a KPI is some kind of a genius thinking when that's the bare minimum we designers fight for. If everyone listened to designers, the world would be in a better place.

6

ChickenLittle2005 • 1y ago

In what area of the post did the dev implied it’s some sort of “genius thinking”? His post served more to informed people. Just because you know, doesn’t mean others do. Get off your arrogance. Your last statement comes across like you have an inferiority complex

8

1 more reply

Loud_Donut • 1y ago

You know they build the things we design right? Don't discount their job nor their knowledge. There are things designers don't understand that engineers could laugh at too. Respect our literal partners. It takes two to tango.

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IniNew • 1y ago
Experienced

The person mentioned the testing because it was important context for the last few sentences, not because they thought it was a revolutionary concept.

2 ...

1 more reply

2 more replies

numberonebarista • 1y ago

I love that you said this. Skip intro was such a game changer that even the sites I watch anime on implemented the feature. I love the very simple but revolutionary UX designs like that.

32 ...

3 more replies

TooftyTV • 1y ago
Veteran

Often with an awesome feature like this it's not difficult in terms of the idea or UX design but it's difficult in terms of the implementation/execution. In this case, I'm sure many people may have thought of this idea way before Netflix but how the heck do you do it consistently?

I agree with you though, it's an awesome feature! And it's kind of genius in terms of how it works and the UX is spot on too

12 ...

Secret-Training-1984 • 1y ago
Experienced

It's easy to overthink this, but the implementation isn't as complex as it might seem at first glance.

Basically, it boils down to a simple timestamp. You mark where the intro ends for one episode, and boom - you've got it for the whole series. It's the same chunk of video every time, right?

From an engineering standpoint, it's pretty straightforward. Once you've got that timestamp, you just need to trigger the "Skip Intro" button to pop up at the right moment and jump to that marked endpoint when clicked. Do it once and you can apply it across the board.

I think what's interesting here is not so much the technical challenge, but the decision to actually do it. Sometimes the best UX solutions are hiding in plain sight. Maybe others thought of it, but didn't push it through. Or maybe they overthought it, assuming it would be more complex than it really was.

Netflix had the conviction to implement it, and once they did, it quickly became a standard feature. It's a classic case of "obvious in hindsight" design. Now every streaming service does it because, well, why wouldn't you?

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karenmcgrane • 1y ago
Veteran

It's not just a timestamp, it's an intellectual property issue. I don't like seeing what's fundamentally a business decision treated as a technical implementation problem, because solving UX problems means solving for the business model.

The opening credits list the performers and crew. Giving the option to skip the credits means negotiating with the content providers to secure the rights to do so. You're right that Netflix had the conviction to do so, but they also had the negotiating power.

Secret-Training-1984 • 1y ago
Experienced

You've made an excellent point. I'll admit, I overlooked the intellectual property angle and that's a key aspect of this feature. Thanks for pointing it out!

ChickenLittle2005 • 1y ago

It's fundamentally multiple issues, business, operations, and tech. You need someone to go in and input those timestamps to know when exactly to skip. It works in cases where all episodes have the same duration and start of the intro. But in instances where they start at different times it's more challenging

5 more replies

TooftyTV • 1y ago
Veteran

Getting the time stamp is the tricky bit! That needs either very consistent AI technology or a lot of manual labour (not literally but you know what I mean)!

It's like the Amazon X-ray feature. Anyone could say 'wouldn't it be cool if you could see what actor is in a scene' but how do you make that data consistently available? Amazon actually uses the manual labour approach quite a lot. Well they used to at least when I worked there many moons ago.

1 more reply

Kratos_s_h • 1y ago

Also I am not sure if you guys have noticed the same thing in netflix skip intro button. is its placement.

Skip to main content

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Because netflix never allows you to play on vertical screen but when you play it on horizontal screen. The button is so near to your thumb holding your phone. (try holding your phone horizontally)

Even to the extent reducing the thumb travel on the screen.

That's some genius ux design.

Delicious_Monk1495 • 1y ago
Veteran

10 second rewind btns

[deleted] • 1y ago

There is this feature on porn sites too, it helps to skip to the main content.

1 more reply

tbimyr • 1y ago
Veteran

Hey Amazon Prime, do you copy?

plzadyse • 1y ago

While the Skip Intro button -is- a great example, there are often limitations to egregious flows or “annoyances” that users face (ex. A consent flow or data collection moment). I would almost argue that the Skip Intro button was very low-hanging fruit that had a momentous impact, not necessarily an example of “genius UX.”

KnightedRose • 1y ago

I have attended a UX conference with a member from Netflix team as one of the speakers. I can't remember all details but I was really amazed by how they tested their video ad. Instead of choosing from 5 vids that they created, they let the respondents give what they like and hate about each of the videos, and that's how they decide what to include and not to include in their final video. If I'm not mistaken this is the vid being played before subscribing to netflix, and the background thumbnails are very specific to every region (or country?) so you can see the top shows and movies there in you area, so what they did is that instead of having to re-edit it again and again, they just have placeholders and just pull out the data, and tada, new updated vids every time.

[deleted] • 1y ago

Skip to main content

Create 2

bbpoizon • 1y ago
Experienced

Netflix UX crushes all around.

2 more replies

[deleted] • 1y ago

One of the things that blows my mind is how people talk about tinder's swiping as something that revolutionized an entire business, not just a UX.

SnowflakeSlayer420 OP • 1y ago

Great example. Similarly, I think Snapchat's story feature and Vine's short videos format also fall in the same category.

HyperionHeavy • 1y ago
Veteran

It may not be a popular thing to say, but this, along with stories and short videos, is IMO an example of the blurry fringes of what makes an experience "good". Yes, all the examples enable a lot of usability and consumability, and engagement, but you can very easily point to how that local expediency contributes to a marginalization of important mental considerations in decision-making with much more global social consequences.

I would love to see the conversations in the industry be able to handle the nuance of local vs global extrema when talking about what constitutes good. Whether we're there yet, hard to say.

Prize_Literature_892 • 1y ago
Veteran

The reason Tinder blew up is because it used the "hot or not" formula and they also went to college campuses to get sorority girls to signup for the app and then go to all the frats to show how there's females on the app and they'd sign up. The swiping thing was catchy for marketing and increasing engagement, but I think they would've been successful either way.

candy4471 • 1y ago
Experienced

It did. It literally changed the use mobile patterns well beyond a dating app. Swiping was not a pattern before tinder. We had a lot of discussions about this when i was getting my masters in human computer interaction because it was only a few years old at that point.

Skip to main content

Create 2

getElephantById • 1y ago
Veteran

The problem is that really excellent UX becomes invisible and is rarely noticed.

An excellent example of this is just how many edge cases and usability improvements are built into the most basic UI components in your operating system. There was a fantastic and deeply humbling talk about this at Config 2023 by Rasmus Andersson (here), which I strongly recommend if you missed it the first time around.

The amount of trial and error, iteration, attention to small details, and commitment to getting it right that went into this is, to me, what genius is about. And if you're like me, you've never thought about these features before, because they just worked, and so seemed perfectly natural and obvious, even though behind the scenes there were a hundred tough decisions and thousands of hours to get them to the point of being totally unnoticeable.

letsgetweird99 • 1y ago
Experienced

Complexity is the private face of simplicity

HyperionHeavy • 1y ago
Veteran

To be clear, people REALLY need to become more familiar with Tesler's law

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Law_of_conservation_of_complexity

1 more reply

poodleface • 1y ago
Experienced

I always tell new folks that the goal of the best UX is to be thoroughly taken for granted.

The initial novelty of the iPhone 1 has long faded into utility. This is just the way we experience touchscreen smartphone devices now, full stop.

DUELETHERNETbro • 1y ago

Ya Luke W. has a great quote about this. "Good design is obvious" but getting there isn't.

For anyone old like me the improvement in payments online is mind boggling. It's basically invisible and expected behavior now but entering your payment information used to suck.

HyperionHeavy • 1y ago
Veteran

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mentions to be more standard as opposed to "wow really?"

Like if you're junior, being wowed by this stuff is fine. But if you're senior and beyond...I can't knock people because we all come from different places, but what are we all doing...

2 more replies

swampy_pillow • 1y ago

Something thats so intuitive and blows my mind how simple it is, is the “pull down to refresh” feature that so many apps have adopted and its now become the norm.

mihaak101 • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago
Veteran

In the infinite scroll paradigm it was somewhat intuitive, because it is basically the opposite of going to the past when scrolling down. So as older content is automatically loaded when you scroll down, so newer content is automatically loaded as you scroll up.

I think its biggest concerns are the invisibility of the interaction to those not familiar with it, or the infinite scrolling paradigm. Another is that it is sometimes applied to illogical situations, such as non-scrollable content or "static" pages (scrollable or not) where values are simply being updated, but no new content is loaded.

cinderful • 1y ago
Veteran

Invented by Loren Brichter, a software engineer who created Tweetie, which was bought by Twitter and turned into their official app.

SBR404 • 1y ago
Experienced

A non-digital example: ATMs that return your card BEFORE handing out your cash.

In general, I always like to use ATMs as an example of something that used to be around for decades, but only got really good in those last few years, thanks to good UX design and the use of modern tech.

I remember using an old ATM in Vancouver, Canada. It used an old ass MS DOS like interface, and would only hand out 5 dollar bills. But the interface still forced you to put in a three digit cash value AND two decimal digits! You had to put in 005,00 Dollars. Needless to say, it handed out the money before returning the card.

EmotionalGoodBoy • 1y ago

Skip to main content

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[deleted] • 1y ago

Cook mode on recipe pages. You toggle it on so your screen doesn't dim or turn off when you have egg and flour covered hands

Venusianflytrapp • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

A genius example would be receiving a verification code to your phone and a pop up of that same code would paste to the original page it sent from. You don't have to manually go back to your text messages , remember a code , and type it in. It respects the users time to get through verification

Venusianflytrapp • 1y ago

Peeing on the fly , reduces mess , saves money on cleaning costs The result was an 80% reduction in spillage, cutting cleaning costs by about 8%

10 more replies

azag00 • 1y ago

Uber Eats "You seem far away from this place" has saved me from a lot of errors while ordering, so I'm going to go with that one.

SirCharlesEquine • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago

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Create 2

an app.

THAT is good UX. I appreciate it every time I use it.

The_Singularious • 1y ago
Experienced

You mean the feature Android introduced two years prior to Apple? Very true.

SirCharlesEquine • 1y ago
Experienced

Thanks for pointing that out. Updating my comment to reflect that.

loginprzyklad • 1y ago

Small haptic feedback when voting on a comment on Reddit

MochiMochiMochi • 1y ago • Edited 1y ago
Veteran

Microsoft Excel. The patterns in that application are how billions of people approach the very idea of tabular data. Granted, some of them predate Excel but Microsoft really put it all together.

Protip: start a data interaction discovery session with an Excel spreadsheet and product owners will love it.

[deleted] • 1y ago

Endless scroll I imagine was pretty incredible when it first came out. Barely any apps have pagination anymore except things like tables and google.

badmamerjammer • 1y ago
Veteran

depends what irs being used for. doomscrolling? sure.

looking thru a list to find something specific? not so much. (what if you want to go back to that item you saw 2 pages ago? how would you ever get to the 500th item? etc)

EyeAlternative1664 • 1y ago
Veteran

Skip to main content

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RammRras • 1y ago

Using vibration as feedback was great and very well made.

EyeAlternative1664 • 1y ago
Veteran

Not even that, just the ability to cancel animations.

letstalkUX • 1y ago
Experienced

Someone had the iPhone's accessibility feature on their phone the other day (the little circle you can move around) and it was so simple but kind of blew my mind

x3leggeddawg • 1y ago
Veteran

Snapchat pull down to refresh is now an intuitive standard for feed UI. I think Snapchat introduced it

The_Singularious • 1y ago
Experienced

Nah. It was part of a Twitter mobile client back in '08. I think some others had picked it up prior to Snapchat even existing.

Funny_Hippo_7508 • 1y ago

The killer rule I ALWAYS come back to is based on Pete Coehn's Great Demo and it's super simple.

Am I one click or less away from where I need to be?

Considering this as user helps remove wasteful steps and clumsy UX/I choices.

Annual-Studio-8643 • 1y ago

Actually making a case study that explains how you solved a problem. Not " pretty " design

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the table columns and directly show you the impact on the right.

most apple products ux are pretty amazing (when they work), like the idea of it just works for apple pencil, apple watch etc, you open them out of the box and it almost automatically starts the setup process.

I cant really remember any off the top of my head at this moment since the greatest ux I have come across just lets me do my thing or really just goes undetected.

ForgotMyAcc • 1y ago
Experienced

I mean, I know this community generally frowns at the sight of Steve Jobs - but the 2007 iPhone was a massive leap in mobile devices that is still standard to this day thanks to the genius UX of the device.

1 more reply

lorzs • 1y ago

The conversational text message interface.

Made me switch from droid to iPhone back in 2011 because all my friends with iPhones who added me to a group chat... resulted in separate messages from each individual (with the old school inbox/outbox style texts)

It was a disaster and incomprehensible to follow or know if the message was to just me or the group. Which depending on the context could be very awkward.

Conversation style texts absolutely changed the way we communicate and experience relationships, with great benefits and possible consequences too (for those predisposed to anxiety for example)

cgielow • 1y ago
Veteran

Graphical User Interfaces (GUI):

The mouse. The undo function. The trashcan.

One-click to buy button (The button "worth a billion dollars" that Amazon patented.)

Natural User Interfaces (NUI):

Multi-touch (pinch to zoom) etc.

Responsive Design in websites (auto resize, reflow.)

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and wearables.

Modern video game controllers with standard two-analog joystick for movement & camera.

Experiential User Interfaces (XUI):

Augmented Reality.

Recommender Systems (Netflix, Amazon, TikTok etc.)

Disney Magic Bands and the experiences they enable.

Apple watch automatically detects what stroke I'm swimming.

Tesla uses your phone as your key and unlocks itself based on your proximity. No on or off button to the car, just get in and drive.

Doorbell cameras. Smart thermostats.

Electric toothbrushes.

GPS mapping. Getting better all the time with more relevant contextual information.

Camera phone innovation. Fixing your photos for you during and after the shot, so that nobody is blinking, you can remove people in the background, that your long-exposures are blur-free. That you can find them via AI-assisted tagging....

Web 2.0:

Social Media, Wikipedia, Reddit.

Telehealth.

Ride sharing and gig work apps.

Web apps. Google docs. Figma.

Physical:

Coffee pods.

Wheels on luggage.

Funktopus_The • 1y ago
Experienced

Might sound ridiculous, but the touchscreen phone. Literally changed the way we live, and it hasn't actually changed that much since its initial release. We still pinch to zoom, drag to scroll, tap to click.

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kodakdaughter • 1y ago
Veteran

Just to counter this a bit b/c I think in general you are right. But for people with mobility challenges and the shakes - it is much worse.

[deleted] • 1y ago

candy4471 • 1y ago
Experienced

Shopify for sellers. It is incredibly intuitive to use, has every feature you could possibly need, features are cohesive across browser and app and the UI is very minimal.

Blando-Cartesian • 1y ago
Experienced

Classic PC keyboard as it commonly was in the late 80's and early 90's. Sounds crazy but hear me out.

The esc key was designed to be easy to hit with commonly less coordinated left hand. It can still be used to close dialogs conveniently (supposed to at least, for accessibility).

The F-keys were originally all for apps to use as hotkeys (by default, no fn-button at all). Some apps had functions listed on the bottom of the screen with the F-key for each, and some came with a paper strip you could place on your keyboard to label the F-keys.

The key switches were mechanical and designed to give great tactile feedback.

Key-caps on keys other than characters were darker shade and keyboards for special purposes could have some custom color key-caps. Some gaming keyboards still have that.

lorzs • 1y ago

There's a whole community of us who will never let the magic of keyboards fade away
r/mechanicalkeyboards

goodmorning_punpunn • 1y ago
Junior

Delhi metro navigation is probably the most user centric thing ive ever seen. its highly highly inclusive, learnable and easy to find around... from new to advanced users

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Mobile check deposit.

[deleted] • 1y ago

harivel • 1y ago

There are many products, which are UX better but my mind always goes to Airbnb. Their way of approaching users perspectives are so unique.

They are the ones who started this right side section as static when scrolling. The idea, which Users can always see, they dont have to go top or bottom for their next action. It's there whenever you need ,Which is mind blowing to me.

[deleted] • 1y ago

Icy-Pie9720 • 1y ago

Are you still watching?

Trishpish420 • 1y ago

Bananas

agrmk • 1y ago

Uber I love it.. especially their use of or more like lack of lack of colors in the UI.. makes it so easy to process without overwhelming and navigating through unnecessary clutter

Wizzlemaine • 1y ago
Veteran

Apple's Dynamic Island. While in practice it isn't used by many apps, it's potential and the idea to turn something people hate into something useful is quite incredible. It's a clever way to quickly show and hide important information in a logical place as well as making it flexible for any app to use.

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X to close a tab in a row of tabs, the X on the next remaining tab would remain in the same place as the number of tabs reduced so you could just repeatedly click to close multiple tabs with the mouse stationary versus have to move the mouse for each tab. It is a little thing but so incredibly thoughtful.

kodakdaughter • 1y ago
Veteran

So many really well done patterns around security. Things I can get my aging mom to use.

Two factor authentication. it's a relatively painless way that actually provides greater security.

Password managers like LastPass.

GoldGummyBear • 1y ago
Experienced

I think many people miss the point here in the comment section. UX is not a feature like a skip button or tinder swipe. Its a holistic experience of a person moving through a product experience, not one single point (or interaction) in time.

zb0t1 • 1y ago
Experienced

Yes, I totally agree with your point.

SnowflakeSlayer420 OP • 1y ago

Good point, these are individual interactions. However, I think people here are pointing out these interactions as the highlight of the overall UX that they enhanced. Improving one touchpoint greatly can elevate the entire experience (in the case of the skip button or swipe feature) as well as moderately improving or optimising all the touchpoints in the journey (in the case of iOS)

candy4471 • 1y ago
Experienced

Disagree. One individual interaction can dramatically change the entire experience a user has with a product.

4 more replies

TractorScare • 1y ago

Why? There is no reason why a small touch point can't be considered as an independent UX by itself.

You can see why there's posts asking why it's so hard to find a UX job..

GoldGummyBear • 1y ago
Experienced

This sub is beginning to feel like an echo chamber for junior designers and boot campers. Its like the blind leading the blind...

kappuru • 1y ago
Veteran

Pull to refresh

pinklesed • 1y ago

Everything Apple does with it's ecosystem.

[deleted] • 1y ago

Especially in guided access mode /s

mr-potato-head • 1y ago

Seems like a weird answer but those blueprint models of company process structures made by ux folks.. I've always been envious and I don't know how to do those. Like any intellectual ux work that doesn't result in user interface I have a hard time at grasping.

[deleted] • 1y ago

I think I know what you are talking about but could you provide an example so I can be sure?

1 more reply

3 more replies

benjaconbalta • 1y ago

Create 2

TheKnickerBocker2521 • 1y ago

Being able to log into your services on your TV through your phone

flora-lai • 1y ago

Ok, the fast forward hold on Tiktok is excellent. Invisible, but so useful.

TA_Trbl • 1y ago
Veteran

I personally hate it lol - give me a button

Whetherwax • 1y ago

There's a weather app called Carrot. It's free, and "ad supported". Except, it doesn't have any real ads. It has ad parodies that are just weird enough that you might click on them, and eventually I did. It just goes to the "upgrade to premium" content.

Related: that upgrade to premium user flow ends with the greatest click shaming I've seen, "if you upgrade now, I promise not to kill a poor, defenseless kitten."

anodyne01 • 1y ago

Pull to refresh

Agreeable-Show3253 • 1y ago

Tiktok's search blue in comments. It's addictive.

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